Worry About the Future

Do we suffer more from what happens, or from what we imagine?

READING · TWO PAGES

Seneca, Letter 13 (“On Groundless Fears”). Many fears never arrive; Seneca asks whether a feared evil is certain before we suffer it.

BEFORE THE MEETING

Announce on your Substack with the question above. Link the letter; reading it ahead is optional.

Open · 10	Read · 10	Discuss · 45	Practice · 15	Close · 10
Ground rules; welcome newcomers	Key passages aloud	The questions below	Five quiet minutes	One takeaway each

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. What future event takes up the most room in your head right now?
2. Think of past worries. How many happened the way you feared?
3. Seneca asks whether the evil is certain. Is that comforting, or dismissive?
4. What’s the difference between planning and worrying?
5. How could calmly imagining the worst help rather than hurt?

PRACTICE THIS MONTH

Rehearse a setback. For five minutes, calmly picture something going wrong, and plan how you’d respond well.

FACILITATOR’S MOVE

“If that’s true, what follows?” Walk a worry forward, step by step, to see where it really leads.

NOTES